

FISH UNDER THREAT



COD

This favorite target of the fishing industry has been virtually fished out from the two main fisheries—the North Sea and the Grand Banks. A female produces millions of eggs when she spawns, but many never get the chance.



TUNA

As oceanic predators, tuna are much rarer than the fish that they prey upon. Pulling them out of the sea to be canned in huge numbers is destroying their small populations, and some species are now in serious danger.



SHARKS

Vast number of sharks are caught so their fins can be cut off for sharks' fin soup. They are then dumped back in the water—often while still alive. This cruel trade is making these slow breeders a rare species.



◀ WHALING

We know how destructive overfishing can be, considering the fate of the world's whales. By the time whaling was virtually banned in 1986, intensive hunting had almost wiped out species like the giant blue whale. Even today, it is very rare because the few survivors breed slowly.



◀ DOLPHIN BYCATCH

All kinds of marine animals are accidentally caught by fishing fleets. Many are fish of the wrong type, while others are air-breathing animals that get trapped in fishing nets and drown. Dolphins often follow tuna shoals, and if the tuna are netted, the dolphins may be caught, too. Despite various systems designed to prevent this, many thousands of dolphins still die every year.



◀ LONGLINING FOR SEABIRDS

Some fish are caught on lines with thousands of baited hooks. As each line streams from the boat into the water, birds like this gannet swoop down to seize the bait. They get hooked, dragged under, and drowned. Up to 100,000 albatrosses die like this each year. Many people are trying to stop the slaughter before most of the 21 species of albatrosses become extinct.